

HM Salsa

10 servings | Very Low Calorie | Zero Fat | Zero Cholesterol

INGREDIENTS

- 4 medium tomatoes, diced
- 5 scallions, chopped
- 1 bunch cilantro, roughly chopped
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 1 tsp black pepper
- Juice of 1/2 lime
- 1/2 Thai red pepper, minced

PREP NOTES

Tomatoes: Roma or vine-ripened tomatoes work best as they have less water content and more concentrated flavor. For a chunkier salsa, dice coarsely. For a finer texture, dice smaller or pulse once or twice in a food processor.

Thai Red Pepper: This is the heat source. Half a pepper gives a moderate heat. For mild salsa, use 1/4 pepper or skip entirely. For extra heat, use the full pepper. Always wash hands thoroughly after handling.

Resting Time: This salsa improves significantly after sitting for at least 30 minutes. The salt draws out moisture from the tomatoes which mingles with the lime juice and creates a more cohesive, flavorful result. Overnight in the refrigerator is ideal.

INSTRUCTIONS

Step 1 - Prep the Tomatoes

Dice the tomatoes into roughly 1/4 inch pieces. Place in a large bowl. Sprinkle with the salt and let sit for 5 minutes - this draws out excess moisture and concentrates the flavor.

Step 2 - Prep Remaining Vegetables

While tomatoes rest, chop the scallions into small rounds using both the white and green parts. Roughly chop the cilantro leaves and tender stems - discard the thick lower stems. Mince the Thai red pepper finely.

Step 3 - Combine

Add the scallions, cilantro, and Thai red pepper to the bowl with the tomatoes. Squeeze the juice of half a lime directly over the mixture. Add the black pepper. Stir everything together gently to combine without crushing the tomatoes.

Step 4 - Taste and Adjust

Taste and adjust as needed. More lime for brightness, more pepper for heat, a pinch more salt if needed. Remember the flavors will develop and intensify as it rests.

Step 5 - Rest Before Serving

Cover and refrigerate for at least 30 minutes before serving. This resting period is important - it allows the flavors to meld and the salt to do its work. Stir once more before serving.

NUTRITION TABLE

Per serving (1 of 10) | Based on 2,000 calorie diet

Nutrient	Per Serving	Daily Value	%DV
Calories	15	—	1%
Total Fat	0.15g	78g	<1%
Saturated Fat	0.02g	20g	<1%

Sodium	115mg	2300mg	5%
Cholesterol	0mg	300mg	0%
Carbohydrates	3.25g	275g	1%
Total Sugars	1.95g	—	—
Added Sugars	0g	50g	0%
Dietary Fiber	1g	28g	4%
Protein	0.73g	50g	1%
Calcium	10.5mg	1300mg	1%
Iron	0.22mg	18mg	1%
Potassium	114.5mg	4700mg	2%

%DV based on 2,000 calorie diet.